

Collects and Biographies for

Saints' Days & Festivals

of the Scottish Episcopal Calendar

October

Using this booklet

This booklet contains a short biography, and appropriate collects, for all saints and dated festivals within the Scottish Calendar published in 1996. It does not provide Post-Communion Prayers.

You may use the short biography as a preface to the Collect of the Day to introduce the life of the saint to the congregation, or as a short homily.

This booklet is arranged with one saint (or festival) to a page, giving details of the saint's day, its category (1-6) and the liturgical colour. Collects for use at a 1970 Scottish Liturgy (or 1929) Eucharist are given on the left, those for 1982 Scottish Liturgy on the right.

Notes

- Where feasts in Category 4 fall on a Sunday (other than a Sunday in Categories 1 and 2), they may, if local circumstances require, be kept on that day.
- When days in Category 6 coincide with a day of higher category, they should be omitted that year.

Key to Abbreviations

ASB	Alternative Service Book 1980 (Church of England)
CCP	Celebrating Common Prayer (Society of St Francis)
DSB	A Diocesan Service Book (L.S. Hunter; OUP, 1965)
ECUSA	Episcopal Church of the United States of America
LFF	The proper for the Lesser Feasts and Fasts, 1991 (ECUSA)
MEG	Malcolm E. Grant, The Revd. Canon
R	The Roman Missal (1970)
SA	An Anglican Prayer Book (Church of the Province of Southern Africa) 1989
SEC	Scottish Episcopal Church Alternative Collects
SPB	Scottish Prayer Book 1929, as amended in 1967

Credits

Originally compiled by the Reverend Canon Malcolm E Grant, and used at the Cathedral of St Andrew, Inverness. This version was edited and repaginated by the Reverend Gareth J M Saunders, Edinburgh, June–October 2003. Additional material was taken from *Exciting Holiness*, Second Edition, 2003.

Version 2.2

1 OCTOBER

Gregory the Enlightener, Bishop, “Apostle of Armenia” (c.332) **[6] *White***

Gregory is called ‘the Enlightener’ because he brought the light of Christ to the people of Armenia towards the end of the third century. Of royal descent, he seems to have become a Christian while in exile in Cappadocia. Returning to Armenia, he eventually converted King Tiridates to Christianity, which then became the official religion of the country. Gregory was consecrated Bishop (Katholikos) in Caesarea in Cappadocia, and was succeeded by his son, who attended the Council of Nicaea.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O God our Father,
who through thy Son Jesus Christ
hast called us out of darkness
into thine own marvellous light,
and didst send thy servant Gregory
to carry that light
to illuminate the people of Armenia:
shine, we beseech thee, in our hearts,
and let the brightness of thy glory
shine throughout the world,
to dispel the darkness of sin and
error,
and to bring all peoples
to the joyful freedom of thy service;
through the same
Jesus Christ our Lord.

(MEG)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

God our Father,
through your Son Jesus Christ
you sent your servant Gregory
to illuminate the people of Armenia
with the light of your salvation:
shine in our hearts, we pray,
and through us
let the brightness of your glory
shine out in the world,
to banish the darkness of sin and
error,
and to bring all people
to the joyful freedom of your service;
through your Son
Jesus Christ our Lord.

(MEG)

4 OCTOBER

Francis of Assisi, Deacon and Friar (1226) [6] *White*

Born at Assisi around the year 1181, the son of a wealthy merchant draper, as a youth Francis lived a frivolous life. Experience of sickness and civil war exerted a steadying influence, and one day, in the ruined church of San Damiano, he had a vision of Christ telling him "Francis, repair my falling house". He took the words literally, and sold a bale of cloth from his father's warehouse to pay for the repairs. His father disowned him, and he went off "to marry Lady Poverty".

He lived by begging, preaching the love of God, and calling people to penitence, and in 1210 the Pope authorized Francis and 11 companions as roving preachers, the birth of the Friars Minor. Recruits flocked to them, and they lived a life of complete poverty and humility, following a rule devised by Francis. With Saint Clare he formed a community for women.

In 1224 while he was praying there appeared on his body scars corresponding to the five wounds of the crucified Christ, which never left him and caused him great pain as well as great consolation. He died two years later.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O God most holy and pitiful,
who didst kindle a flame of love
in the heart of Saint Francis,
so that it became wholly thine:
increase in us the same faith
and power of love,
that as we rejoice in his humility
and victorious deeds
we may know the secret
of his perfect joy;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(DSB)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

O God,
you ever delight
to reveal yourself
to the childlike and lowly of heart:
grant that, following the example
of your servant Francis,
we may count the wisdom
of the world as foolishness
and know only Jesus Christ
and him crucified;
who is alive and reigns with you
and the Holy Spirit,
one God, now and for ever.

(CCP)

8 OCTOBER

Alexander Penrose Forbes, Bishop (1875) [6] *White*

The son of Lord Medwyn, a judge of the Court of Session, he served with the East India Company for three years, but returned to Britain on health grounds, to study at Oxford. Profoundly influenced by Pusey, he was presented by him to a slum parish in Leeds in 1847, but a few months later, at the age of 30, he was elected Bishop of Brechin.

In Dundee he was conspicuous for his self-sacrifice for the poor, and his care in tending the victims of a cholera epidemic, heedless of the risks to himself. He built the present Cathedral for his own congregation, and founded several new congregations in the city. His 'high' sacramental teaching led him into serious controversy with the other bishops. His writings included doctrinal and devotional work as well as research into the lives of the saints in Scotland. He died in 1875.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O God the light of the faithful
and Shepherd of souls,
who hast adorned our church
by the life and teaching
of Bishop Alexander Penrose Forbes:
illuminate us with the same love
for thy dear Son,
and inspire us to see all people
as those for whom Christ died,
that we may serve and glorify him
by the compassion
we show to others,
and so make known the new life
which he came to share with us;
who now liveth and reigneth with
thee and the Holy Spirit,
one God, world without end.

(MEG)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Loving Shepherd of your people,
you greatly enriched our church
by the life and teaching
of Bishop Alexander Penrose Forbes:
illuminate us with the same love
for your dear Son,
and inspire us to see every person
as someone for whom Christ died,
that we may serve and glorify him
by the compassion
we show to others,
and so make known the new life
which he came to share with us;
who is alive and reigns
with you and the Holy Spirit,
one God, now and for ever.

(MEG)

11 OCTOBER

Kenneth, Abbot (600) [6] *White*

Kenneth, or Canice, was born around AD 525 in Derry, and was a fellow student with Saint Columba. He moved to Wales, where he studied under Saint Cadoc, and learned the language of the Britons and the Picts. He returned to Ireland, where he established several monasteries, notably Aghaboe, and is later again linked with Columba, especially on his visit to the Pictish King, Brude, in Inverness.

There are many dedications to him in the islands and sea-board of western Scotland and in Fife. St Kenneth's Abbey in St Andrews, the earliest establishment there, is said in the Roman tradition to be of his founding. The only mediaeval cathedral to survive in Ireland at Kilkenny is dedicated in his honour. A lonely figure, he copied the scriptures and became known as the preacher who loved the countryside and animal life. He died in Ireland, at Aghaboe, around the year 600.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty and everlasting God,
whose servant Kenneth
carried the good news
of thy beloved Son
to the dark places of the world:
grant, we beseech thee,
that we who celebrate
with thanksgiving
his life and example,
may know the hope of the gospel
in our hearts,
and manifest its light in all our ways;
through the same thy Son,
Jesus Christ our Lord.

(ASB – adapted)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

God our Father,
you called us out of darkness
into your marvellous light,
and gave us your servant Kenneth
to bring the light of the gospel
to our shores:
shine in our hearts, we pray,
and enable us to proclaim your love;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(SA – adapted)

12 OCTOBER

Elizabeth Fry (1845) [6] *White*

Born at Norwich in 1780, the daughter of a banker, she married a London merchant who was a strict Quaker, by whom she had a large family, in 1808 she established a girls' school, and became a noted speaker among the Quakers.

In 1813 her interest was aroused by the appalling conditions in our prisons, and she began regular visits to the female prisoners in Newgate, where her Bible readings made a deep impression. For many years she campaigned fearlessly for prison reform in Britain and later in Europe. She also helped to establish a night shelter for the homeless in London in 1820. All her philanthropic work was inspired by her strong faith, and linked with evangelism. She died in 1845.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Loving and merciful Father of all,
who hast built up thy Church
through the love and devotion
of thy saints, and didst inspire thy
servant Elizabeth Fry with an
abundant compassion for the poor
and those in prison: strengthen us by
thy Holy Spirit, that our hearts may
be ablaze with love for thee and for
others, for thy dear sake; through
Jesus Christ our Lord.

(MEG from SA)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
you inspired your servant
Elizabeth Fry
with an immense compassion
for sinners and captives,
and through her advocacy
caused great reforms to be made
in the prisons of our land:
look in pity on all those
who are now held in prison,
and in your mercy free us all
from the slavery of sin
and help us to love and serve you
in true freedom of spirit;
through Jesus Christ our Lord
(R for Raymond Penafort – adapted)

15 OCTOBER

Teresa of Avila, Teacher of the Faith (1582) [6] *White*

Born at Avila in Spain in 1515, she joined the Carmelite Order although she dreaded leaving her family. She soon made rapid progress in contemplation, despite serious ill-health and the general laxity of the community. She was frequently rapt in ecstasy, and her spiritual writings place her in the first rank of mystical theologians, justifying her place among the Doctors of the Church.

A practical and shrew woman, she undertook the reform of her Order, despite strong opposition and the first house of discalced Carmelites was opened in 1562. Thereafter she travelled widely throughout Spain establishing other small, poor, strictly enclosed and highly disciplined convents, and under her influence the reform spread to the men of the Order, the most significant of their leaders being Saint John of the Cross.

She died in 1582.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O merciful Father,
who by thy Holy Spirit
didst raise up thy servant
Teresa of Avila
to show thy Church
the way of perfection;
grant, we beseech thee,
that her inspired teaching
may awaken in us
a longing for true holiness,
until that day when, by thy mercy,
we attain to the perfect union of
love;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(CCP – adapted)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Merciful Father,
by your Spirit
you raised up your servant
Teresa of Avila
to show your Church
the way of perfection;
grant that her inspired teaching
may awaken in us
a longing for true holiness,
until that day
when we attain to the
perfect union of love;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(CCP)

17 OCTOBER

Ignatius of Antioch, Bishop and Martyr (c.115) [6] *Red*

Ignatius, probably of Syrian origin, was the second bishop of Antioch after Saint Peter. In old age he was sentenced to death for his faith, and sent to Rome to be thrown to wild beasts at the public games. On his journey to Rome he wrote seven letters, dealing wisely with the teachings of Jesus, Christian living, and questions of the constitution of the Church, which give invaluable insights into the beliefs and practice of the post-Apostolic Church. His letter to the Roman Church, in which he begs then not to try to secure his release, reveals a patient, gentle person, passionately devoted to Christ. His death occurred around the year AD 107, possibly in the Colosseum.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Renew in thy Church,
we beseech thee, O Lord,
the courage of Ignatius the Martyr,
the fervour of his letters
and the faithfulness of his teaching:
that we may so burn
with love towards thee
as to care for nought else
but to do thy will,
whatever be the cost in suffering,
or in death itself:
through Jesus Christ our Lord.
(ECUSA – LFF)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
whose servant Ignatius
zealously proclaimed
the true humanity of Christ
and witnessed to him,
both in life and in death:
keep the Church firm in its faith,
and grant us
all the grace of our Saviour,
Jesus Christ,
who lives and reigns
with you and the Holy Spirit,
one God, now and for ever.
(CCP)

18 OCTOBER

Luke, Evangelist [4] *White (or Red)*

Luke was a physician, born of a pagan family, who became a Christian, and accompanied Saint Paul on parts of his missionary journeys, and was with him in Rome. He was with Paul during the time of his imprisonment in Caesarea, and it may have been then that he collected the stories unique to his Gospel, including the narratives of the birth and childhood of Jesus, several miracles and about twenty parables. He was the author of the Gospel which bears his name and of the Acts of the Apostles.

We know nothing of what happened to Luke after the martyrdom of Paul, but early tradition claims that he wrote his Gospel in Greece, and that he died in Boeotia. The tradition that he was martyred is not well-founded, and this is now widely doubted.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
who callest Luke the Physician,
whose praise is in the Gospel,
to be an Evangelist,
and Physician of the soul:
may it please thee that,
by the wholesome medicine
of the doctrine delivered by him,
all the diseases of our souls
may be healed;
through the merits of thy Son
Jesus Christ our Lord.

(SPB)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
you called Luke the physician,
whose praise is in the Gospel,
to be an evangelist,
and physician of the soul:
by the grace of the Spirit
and through the wholesome
medicine of the gospel,
give your Church the same love and
power to heal;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(SEC)

19 OCTOBER

Henry Martyn, Priest and Missionary (1812) [6] *White*

Born at Truro in 1781, Henry Martyn became a Fellow of St John's College, Cambridge, where his acquaintance with Charles Simeon awakened an interest in missionary work. He became a chaplain of the East India Company at Calcutta in 1805, and as well as evangelistic work amongst the indigenous population, he translated the New Testament and the Prayer Book into Hindustani, and the New Testament into Persian and Arabic.

He moved to Persia in 1811, and at Shirmas engaged in theological discussion with learned Muslims. He died on this day in 1812 on a journey to Constantinople, and was buried in the Armenian city of Tokat with the honours usually reserved for a bishop of their own church.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty and everlasting God,
we thank thee
for thy servant Henry Martyn,
whom thou didst call
to preach the Gospel
to the people of India and Persia:
raise up, we beseech thee,
in this and every land
evangelists and heralds of thy
kingdom,
that thy Church may proclaim
the unsearchable riches
of our Saviour Jesus Christ:
who liveth and reigneth
with thee and the Holy Spirit,
one God, now and for ever.

(ECUSA)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

O God of the nations,
you gave your servant,
Henry Martyn a brilliant mind,
a loving heart,
and a gift for languages,
which he consecrated
to making known
the Good News of Your Son:
inspire in us a love like his,
that we may be eager
to commit our life and our talents
in the service of him who gave them,
your Son Jesus Christ,
who lives and reigns
with you and the Holy Spirit,
one God, now and for ever,

(ECUSA - LFF)

23 OCTOBER
James of Jerusalem, Martyr (c.62) [6] *Red*

James, "the Lord's brother", was a leader of the Church in Jerusalem from a very early date, and is regarded as its first bishop. Though not one of the Twelve, Paul includes James among those to whom the risen Lord appeared before His ascension, and records that he received him cordially when he visited Jerusalem after his conversion. He was regarded as the leader of the Jewish community when the Church expanded to embrace the Gentiles, and was successful in bringing many of his fellow Jews to faith in Christ. He presided at the Council of Jerusalem. He was stoned to death by the Sanhedrin in the year AD 62.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Grant, we beseech thee, O God,
that after the example
of thy servant James the Just,
brother of our Lord,
thy Church may give itself
continually to prayer
and to the reconciliation
of all who are at variance and
enmity;
through the same
our Lord Jesus Christ,
who liveth and reigneth
with thee and the Holy Spirit,
one God, now and for ever.

(ECUSA)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Lord God of peace:
grant that after the example
of your servant Saint James
the brother of our Lord
your Church may give itself
continually to prayer
and to the reconciliation
of all who are caught up
in hatred or enmity;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(SA)

28 OCTOBER

Simon and Jude, Apostles [4] *Red*

Nothing is known of the lesser apostle called Simon than that he is described as 'the Zealot', but it is uncertain whether this refers to his zeal for the Jewish law or to membership of one of the factions committed to the overthrow of the Roman invaders. In either case, his fellowship with Matthew, the tax-collector, testifies to the power of Jesus to reconcile those who would naturally have been sworn enemies.

'Judas (not Iscariot)' is mentioned by John during the long discourses after the Last Supper, and is usually identified with Thaddaeus (or Lebbaeus), which may have been his last name, in the other lists of the Twelve. If he is identified with the author of the New Testament Epistle of Jude, he was also the brother of James, and one of the so-called brethren of the Lord.

The two apostles are joined together on 28 October because a church which had recently acquired their relics was dedicated to their memory in Rome on this day in the seventh century.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O Almighty God,
who hast built thy Church
upon the foundation
of the Apostles and Prophets,
Jesus Christ himself
being the head corner-stone:
Grant us so to be joined together
in unity of spirit by their doctrine,
that we may be made an holy temple
acceptable unto thee;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(SPB)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

O Almighty God,
who built your Church
upon the foundation
of the Apostles and Prophets,
Jesus Christ himself
as the chief corner-stone:
so join us together in unity of spirit
by their doctrine,
that we may be made a holy temple
acceptable to you;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(SEC)

29 OCTOBER

James Hannington, Bishop and Companions, Martyrs (1885) **[6] *Red***

James Hannington was born in 1847 of a Congregationalist family but he became an Anglican before going up to Oxford. He was ordained and, after serving a curacy for five years, went with the Church Missionary Society, to Zanzibar with 6 companions in 1882, at the age of 35. Less than a year later he was forced back to England, suffering from fever and dysentery.

After his recovery he was consecrated the first Bishop of Eastern Equatorial Africa in 1884, and returned to Africa, landing at Mombassa in January 1885. In October of that year, during an expedition to find a shorter route to Lake Victoria Nyanza, he and his companions were apprehended by emissaries of the fanatically anti-Christian Ugandan King Mwanga, and after a week of cruel privations and torture they were butchered to death on this day in 1885. Hannington's last words were, "Go, tell Mwanga I have purchased the road to Uganda with my blood", and many other Christians were to die before the Gospel was firmly planted in Uganda.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O Almighty God,
who didst give to thy servant
James Hannington
courage to proclaim
the Name of Jesus Christ
and to die for this faith:
grant that we may ever labour
to make known
the good news of thy love,
and be ready to suffer gladly
for that Name; for his sake,
who now liveth and reigneth
with thee and the Holy Spirit,
one God, world without end.

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Most merciful God,
you strengthened your Church
by the steadfast courage
and devotion
of your bishop and martyr
James Hannington:
grant that we also,
thankfully remembering
his victory of faith,
may overcome what is evil
and glorify your holy Name;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(CCP – adapted)

(MEG from ECUSA)

October

1	Gregory the Enlightener, Bishop, c.332	6	White
2	—	—	—
3	—	—	—
4	Francis of Assisi, Deacon and Friar, 1226	6	White
5	—	—	—
6	—	—	—
7	—	—	—
8	Alexander Penrose Forbes, Bishop, 1875	6	White
9	—	—	—
10	—	—	—
11	Kenneth, Abbot, 600	6	White
12	Elizabeth Fry, 1845	6	White
13	—	—	—
14	—	—	—
15	Teresa of Avila, Teacher of the Faith, 1582	6	White
16	—	—	—
17	Ignatius of Antioch, Bishop and Martyr, c.115	6	White
18	Luke, Evangelist	4	White
19	Henry Martyn, Priest and Missionary, 1812	6	White
20	—	—	—
21	—	—	—
22	—	—	—
23	James of Jerusalem, Martyr, c.62	6	Red
24	—	—	—
25	—	—	—
26	—	—	—
27	—	—	—
28	Simon and Jude, Apostles	4	Red
29	James Hannington, Bp and Companions, Martyrs, 1885	6	Red
30	—	—	—
31	—	—	—